

Project Report: SkillBridge

1. Planning: The Vision and The Team

Goal: To build a specialized, dual-sided freelance portal that solves the experience catch-22 for students while providing affordable, agile support for small businesses.

Our Collaborative Approach:

To manage the workload efficiently, we assigned specific leadership roles to streamline development:

- **Technical Leads:** Designated leads for GitHub, CSS, HTML, and JavaScript ensured quality control.
- **Workflow:** We paired each team member with a specific HTML page and its corresponding JavaScript file to foster individual ownership. Once a lead’s core tasks were completed, they pivoted to support others, ensuring no one was left behind.
- **Version Control:** We implemented a professional workflow using 7 Git branches. Each of the 6 team members operated on a dedicated branch, utilizing Pull Requests to merge work into the main branch.

2. Analysis: Bridging the Gap

SkillBridge stands out by focusing on the micro-gig model. Unlike LinkedIn or Upwork, which favor seasoned professionals, SkillBridge is designed for the early-career student:

Feature	LinkedIn / Upwork	SkillBridge
Primary Audience	Global experts and recruiters	Local students and small businesses
Barrier to Entry	High (Experience-heavy)	Zero (Built for portfolios)
Project Nature	Large-scale and cutthroat	Bite-sized, achievable micro-gigs

3. Design and Development

We utilized Figma for wireframes, focusing on a clean, accessible interface that helps small businesses match with students based on specific coding modules. Our GitHub Lead oversaw the

architectural integrity, while our JavaScript Lead performed final code reviews to ensure consistency across all modules.

4. Challenges and Growth

The greatest hurdle we faced was initial ambiguity regarding the project brief. As a team, we had to work hard to align our understanding of the requirements.

We moved from individual confusion to collective clarity by leaning on each other's strengths. By the end, our greatest success wasn't just the code; it was the way we supported one another to overcome communication gaps and deliver our best work.

5. Testing and Deployment

Through our Pull Request system, the team performed peer reviews to identify and fix bugs before merging to the main branch. We successfully moved from the planning phase to a functional, responsive web application that serves as a launchpad for our careers and a resource for local entrepreneurs.